

Frozen Lemon-Ginger-Turmeric Shots

When hot water is poured over these frozen lemon-ginger-turmeric ice cubes, they melt to create a soothing hot beverage that's perfect for cold and flu season. Both ginger and turmeric are packed with anti-inflammatory compounds, which have been shown to support immunity. Bright, strong and punchy, you'll want to sip on this beverage all day long.

By **Alex Loh** | Updated on September 23, 2025

 Reviewed by Dietitian **Christa Brown, M.S., RDN, LD**

Active Time: 10 mins

Total Time: 1 hr 10 mins

Servings: 8

Nutrition Profile:

Diabetes-Friendly Nut-Free Dairy-Free Soy-Free Heart-Healthy Vegetarian Egg-Free Gluten-Free

Ingredients

1 cup fresh lemon juice (from about 4 lemons)

½ cup chopped fresh ginger (about 9 inches; see Tip)

2 tablespoons chopped fresh turmeric (about 3 inches) *or* 2 teaspoons ground turmeric

3 tablespoons honey

1 tablespoon water

⅛ teaspoon cracked black pepper

Directions

Step 1

Combine lemon juice, ginger, turmeric, honey, water and pepper in a blender; process until smooth, 30 seconds to 1 minute.

Step 2

Strain the juice through a fine-mesh strainer into a large measuring cup, pressing solids with a spoon to extract juice; you should have about 1 cup of juice. Discard solids.

Step 3

Evenly pour the juice into a 9-ounce silicone ice cube tray. Freeze until solid, at least 1 hour.

Step 4

To make 1 serving: Bring 8 ounces water to a boil. Place 1 frozen cube in a mug or heatproof glass; add the hot water. Serve immediately.

Equipment

9-ounce silicone ice cube tray

Frequently Asked Questions

Can I use bottled lemon juice in place of fresh lemon juice? ✓

Bottled lemon juice can be a handy swap when cooking, but it may not be the best solution for this beverage. The pasteurization process gives bottled lemon juice a muted taste and aroma compared to fresh-squeezed, and some bottled lemon juice contains additives to keep it shelf stable. We're "#teamfresh," but if you do buy the bottled stuff, look for a bottle labeled "100% pure juice" with lemon juice as the only ingredient.

Is the honey necessary, or can I leave it out? ✓

Turmeric and ginger contribute earthiness and a hint of bitterness, while lemon juice adds acidity. A small amount of honey perfectly balances the overall flavor profile. While you can reduce the honey or omit it entirely, doing so may make the other flavors more pronounced and intense.

How long can I store ginger-turmeric shots? ✓

We prefer freezing the shots in an ice cube tray, as this method keeps them fresh for longer—up to 3 months. Alternatively, you can prepare a week's worth of shots and store them in 2-ounce glass bottles in the refrigerator. However, keep in mind that the potency of refrigerated juice will diminish after 48 hours.

Can I add an extra flavoring? ✓

We recommend trying our recipe as it is for your first batch. Experiment with it in your next batch. Consider sweetening it with coconut water or agave syrup instead of honey, or adding an herbal touch with lemon balm or mint. You might even add a little hot sauce if you enjoy drinks with a kick. Alternatively, you can incorporate the shot into a delicious smoothie or iced tea.

Can I use the leftover pulp? ✓

You will have some leftover pulp from making this recipe. While you can certainly add it to your compost bin like any other fruit pulp, consider getting a bit creative with it! You can use the pulp in baked goods, soups, spreads or smoothies.

Recipe developed by Catherine Jessee

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Nutrition Facts

Per serving: **Serving Size 1 (1-oz.) cube** 38 calories; sodium 1mg; total carbohydrate 10g; total sugars 8g; added sugars 0g; vitamin c 11mg; calcium 3mg; potassium 40mg

Additional reporting by Carrie Myers, M.S., Sara Haas, RDN, LDN, and Linda Frahm

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